

1. Before the Session (Preparation)

- **Platform:** All classes are conducted via online video calls using **Zoom**.
- **Getting the Link:** The Zoom link is always pinned in the description of the student's designated WhatsApp group. Parents and students can find it there at any time.

2. During the Session (Live Class)

- **The Instructor:** Always refer to the instructor as the **Captain**.
- **Session Activities:** The Captain will explain chess concepts, strategies, and interact with the students through Zoom.
- **App Requirements:** Students **do not** usually need to open Lichess or Chesskid during the live Session. They only need to focus on the Zoom meeting unless the Captain specifically requests otherwise.

3. After the Session (Homework & Practice)

- **The Challenge:** After the Session ends, the Captain will send a specific challenge to the student's WhatsApp group.
- **Format:** These challenges are typically chess puzzles hosted on **Lichess**.
- **Expectation:** The student must complete these Lichess puzzles to apply what they learned before the next Session.
- **Support Protocol:** If a student or parent cannot find the pinned Zoom link, cannot find the puzzle challenge in the group, or does not understand what is required, reassure them and guide them based on this document. If they need further technical help, assign them to the @service team.

Comprehensive Operational & Training Manual

1. Account Creation & Technical Setup

- **Device Recommendation:** We highly recommend using a laptop or tablet for Zoom and chess platforms (rather than a mobile phone) so the chess board is clear and easy to interact with.
- **ChessKid Accounts:** ThinkTree creates the student ChessKid accounts directly from our academy account. Parents do not need to create these.
- **Lichess Accounts:** Parents/students must create their own Lichess accounts.
- **Helpful Video Tutorials (Share these links when asked):**

- How to Create an Account on Lichess: <https://youtu.be/fkzX5ib3ijc>
- How to Join ThinkTree Team and Join a Tournament on Lichess: <https://youtu.be/1MQct4oHb7U>
- How to Join a Tournament on ChessKid: <https://youtu.be/clBgF8DFXAQ>

2. The Weekly Training Cycle

- **Course Structure:** Sessions are held weekly. One full course level consists of 8 Sessions (taking about 8 weeks).
- **Before the Session:** Classes are conducted via **Zoom**. The Zoom link is permanently pinned in the description of the student's designated WhatsApp group.
- **During the Session:** The instructor is called the **Captain**. Students do not usually need to open Lichess or ChessKid during the live Session unless the Captain requests it.
- **After the Session:** The Captain will send a challenge (usually chess puzzles on Lichess) to the WhatsApp group. Students must complete these puzzles to practice.

3. Absences, Makeup Classes & Recordings

- **Absence Policy:** Parents can notify us at any time if a student is sick or will miss a Session.
- **Recordings:** If a student misses a class, ThinkTree provides the Session recordings and all Session materials.
- **Action Required:** All rescheduling and absence issues must be assigned to the **Customer Service team (@service)** to arrange makeup classes or provide the recordings.

4. Progress Tracking & Parent Reports

- **Official Reports:** ThinkTree sends an official, comprehensive progress report to parents at the end of the level (after Session 8).
- **Internal Tracking:** The Captain records feedback after every single Session, but this is internal. We do not send session-by-session reports to parents.
- **On-Demand Updates:** If a parent explicitly asks for an update on their child's progress before the level ends, we can provide it, but the official evaluation happens after the 8th week.

5. Tournaments & Community

- **Frequency:** Tournament schedules are currently under development.

- **Mandatory?** Tournaments are highly encouraged for practice but are NOT mandatory.
- **The Community:** All tournament details, announcements, and links are shared on the ThinkTree Community WhatsApp group.
- **Community Link:** <https://chat.whatsapp.com/FjQUltZ3fwTIWwXWqIlVdc>